NCERT CURIOSITY • CHAPTER 6

CLASS 7 SCIENCE

ADOLESCENCE: A STAGE OF GROWTH AND CHANGE

Your body grows. Your feelings change. Everyone's timeline is different.



Inside this workbook

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NCERT textbook questions: complete answers

How to study

These answers follow *Curiosity*, Chapter 6, textbook pages 85–87. The question headings below are shortened; every numbered question and its subparts are answered. Use your own words in examinations.

Q1 • Ramesh develops pimples at age 11

(i) Causes: Hormonal changes during adolescence can increase oily secretions from the skin. Oil may block pores, leading to acne and pimples.
(ii) Relief: Gently wash the face, keep skin clean, avoid squeezing or picking pimples, and seek medical advice if acne is persistent, painful or severe.
Why? Acne during puberty is common and not a sign of poor character or uncleanliness.

Q2 • Choose the better food group (textbook pictures)

Answer. **Picture (ii): the balanced Indian meal** with foods such as roti, vegetables, pulses/dal and other nutritious components. It is a better everyday option than picture (i), which shows mainly burgers, fries and other energy-dense fast foods.
Why? Adolescents need a variety of nutrients for rapid growth: carbohydrates for energy, proteins for growth and repair, iron for blood, calcium for bones, and vitamins/minerals for health.
Remember: No single meal supplies every nutrient by itself; aim for variety across the day.

Q3 • Unscramble all four underlined words

(i) `nstmnoiaretu` → **menstruation**.
(ii) `iceov xob` → **voice box**.
(iii) `urtypeb` → **puberty**.
(iv) `lahoclo` and `srugd` → **alcohol** and **drugs**.

Q4 • Shalu says adolescence means only physical changes

Answer. **No.** Adolescence involves physical changes (growth, body hair, changing voice), **internal/biological changes** (reproductive maturation), and **emotional and behavioural changes** (new interests, mood changes, growing independence, and changing friendships). All are part of growing up.

Q5 • Ask questions to test two classmates' claims

(i) "Behavioural changes do not matter." Ask: "Can moods, peer pressure or decisions affect friendships, learning and well-being?" **Yes**; learning to handle these changes matters.
(ii) "Trying a harmful substance once is easy to stop." Ask: "Can addictive substances create cravings and make stopping difficult?" **Yes**; tobacco, alcohol and drugs may be addictive, so avoiding them is safest.

Q6 • Behaviour changes besides mood swings

Answer. Adolescents may show increased curiosity, a wish for independence and privacy, stronger friendships, new interests, self-consciousness about appearance, sensitivity to criticism, and influence from peers. Changes vary among individuals.
Helpful action: Talk to a trusted adult, take time before reacting and practise respectful communication.

Q7 • Menstrual and sanitary hygiene

Answer. Use a clean and suitable menstrual product; change it regularly as needed; wash hands before and after changing; maintain body cleanliness; wrap used disposable pads and put them in the appropriate bin; **do not litter or flush pads**. Reusable products should be cleaned and dried as directed. Provide privacy, water, soap and access to bins.
Why? Menstruation is a natural biological process; shame and isolation are not scientifically justified.

Q8 • Mary and Manoj have neck swellings

Answer. **Mary:** A swelling treated by a doctor with advice about iodine-rich food may be related to an enlarged thyroid (goitre) associated with iodine deficiency; the doctor should diagnose it. **Manoj:** A noticeable bump in the throat during puberty may be the growing **voice box (Adam's apple)**, which is usually a normal change.
Why? The location of a bump alone cannot establish its cause; Mary needed clinical assessment, while Manoj's bump was judged a normal pubertal change by his doctor.

Q9 • Categorise all seven physical changes

Mainly observed in boys	Mainly observed in girls	Common in both
(i) Marked voice deepening; (iii) growth of moustache; (iv) prominent facial hair	(ii) development of breasts	(v) pimples; (vi) pubic hair; (vii) armpit hair

Note: The textbook's categories describe typical patterns, not absolute rules. Voice and body hair can change in everyone, with wide individual variation.

Q10 • Poster about healthy adolescence

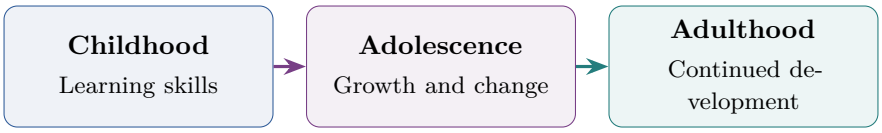
GROW HEALTHY, GROW CONFIDENT!

Eat varied, balanced meals • Drink water • Be active
Sleep well • Keep clean • Respect others
Protect your privacy online • Say NO to tobacco, alcohol and drugs
Ask for help when you need it. Everyone grows at their own pace.

Poster tip: Use a clear heading, short points and a large central picture.

Understand the chapter with pictures

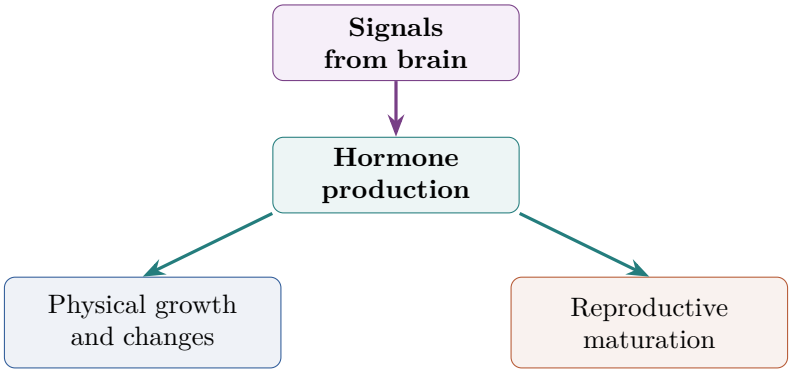
1. From childhood to adulthood



Two definitions students must know

Adolescence: Transitional period, usually from about 10 to 19 years, in which the body, emotions and behaviour develop towards adulthood.
Puberty: The stage of internal and observable changes through which the body gains reproductive maturity. Puberty occurs during adolescence.

2. What changes, and why?



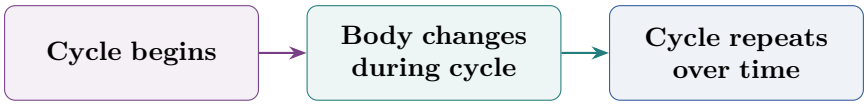
Remember: no two clocks run the same way

The starting age, speed and extent of puberty vary naturally among individuals. Comparison with a friend is not a reliable measure of health or maturity.

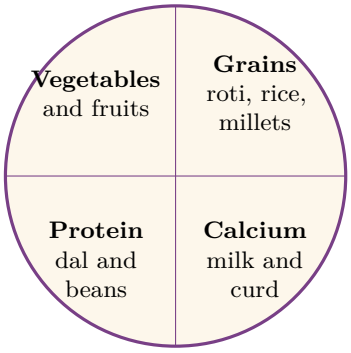
3. Menstruation: a natural cycle

A straightforward explanation

During adolescence, menstrual cycles may begin. **Menstruation** is the part of the menstrual cycle when blood and tissue leave the body. The textbook describes cycles often around **28–30 days**, though **21–35 days** may also be healthy; bleeding often lasts **3–7 days**. Individual cycles can vary. Menstruation is normal and does not make a person impure.



4. Balanced food builds strong bodies



Also important: water, physical activity, sleep and variety

Iron sources: green leafy vegetables, pulses, beans and dried fruits

Practical habits and emotional well-being

Do: every day

- Eat varied, nourishing food.
- Move, play or exercise regularly.
- Keep your body and clothes clean.
- Get adequate sleep and rest.
- Treat friends kindly and respect privacy.
- Talk to a trusted adult when worried.

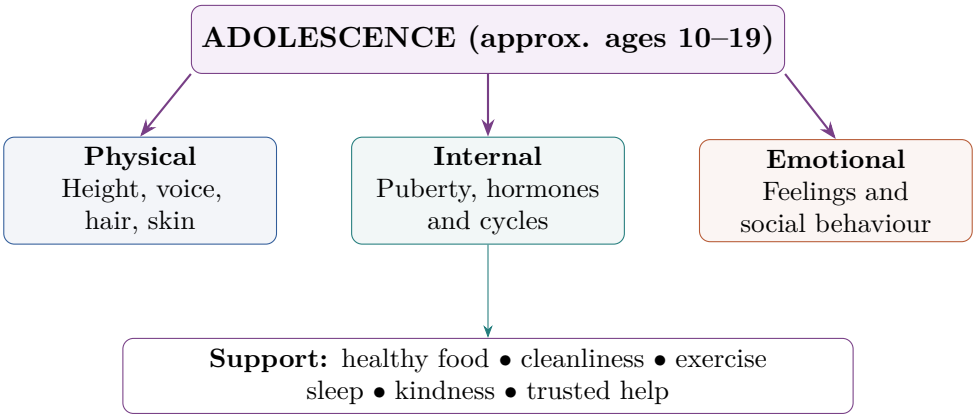
Stay safe offline and online

- Think before posting or sharing.
- Don't share private details with strangers.
- Report bullying and ask for help.
- Avoid tobacco, alcohol and illegal drugs.
- Do not accept pressure to try harmful substances.

Common mistake

Incorrect: "Puberty happens at the same age for everyone", "menstruation is an illness", "mood swings mean something is wrong with a person", or "one use of an addictive substance can never cause problems".
Correct: Development varies; menstruation is natural; emotions benefit from understanding; addictive substances pose risks.

One-page concept map



Test yourself in five minutes

1. Define adolescence and puberty in one sentence each.
2. Why can pimples appear in adolescence?
3. Name two emotional/behavioural changes.
4. What is menstruation? Give one hygiene practice.
5. Give two ways to respond to peer pressure involving harmful substances.

Answers to the five-minute check

1. Adolescence: gradual transition toward adulthood; puberty: bodily changes leading to reproductive maturity. 2. Increased oily skin secretions can clog pores. 3. E.g., new interests and changing moods. 4. Natural shedding of blood/tissue during the cycle; use a clean product and dispose of it correctly. 5. Say no confidently and seek support from a trusted adult.

Think like a kind and informed classmate

A friend is worried because they are growing faster or slower than others. What can you say? **Sample response:** "Growing at a different pace is common. If something worries you, we can ask a trusted adult or healthcare professional together."

Source: NCERT Curiosity, Grade 7 Science, Chapter 6 (2025). These are original student-friendly notes; textbook questions are paraphrased and answered in order.